

Hearing loss, what's that?

The law suit against Apple holding it responsible for hearing loss allegedly caused by iPods may finally be dismissed



Hindsight

This here is the first ever CD player manufactured by Sony back in the 80s. At the time it cost \$1000!

DIY

product. It is an audio player with the functionality of a web browser too, which has been utilised properly to provide you with augmented information about your current playing file and a music store.

It's a complete feature by feature match for iTunes and more. Like most modern day players, it support skins and plug-ins, a function which seems obvious, given its roots in the Mozilla's XULRunner framework. Nearly four years into development it has become a player of choice today for users on all platforms.

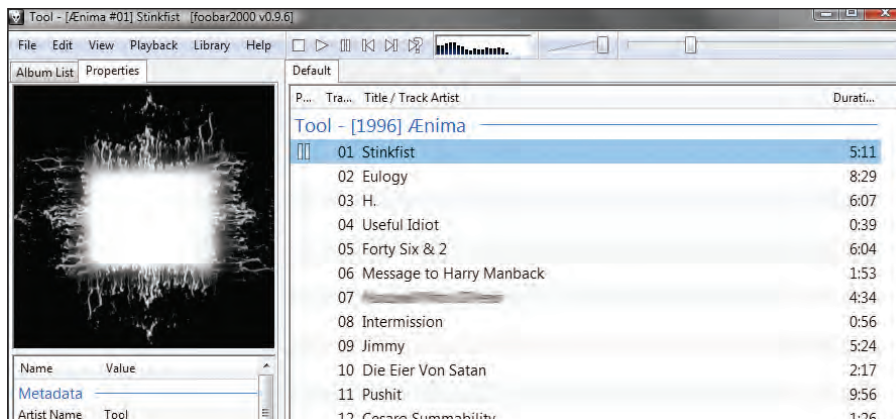
iPod support comes in form of an add-on, which is also currently one of the most download add-ons for songbird. Functionality includes syncing and transfer for your music as well as videos. It can also sync your playlist between your iPod and hard disk based collection. Support for firmware 2.x and above on iPhone/iPod Touch is a little sketchy and will require a jail broken version.

To sum it up, we'd say it's a stable feature-full player with active development and immense community support, but nearly as heavy as iTunes in terms of resource usage.



Amarok2

Available for the Linux platform, Amarok2 is a KDE-based music player with an interface to die for. It is widely regarded as the best Audio Player around in terms of interface and features across the gazillion choices in the Linux and Windows world. If you want to sync the latest iteration of



Foobar - strong competitor to MediaMonkey and extremely customisable

iPhone/iTouch, it must be jail broken for Amarok2 to support it properly.

Foobar2000

It prides itself at being the most customisable audio player on the planet. You can turn Foobar2000 into a full-fledged music manager or ultra-light bare bone music player via add-ons and plug-ins. Its feature rich, but just that setting up Foobar2000 with correct and complete customisation can be a bit of a pain for a new user.

Winamp

Considered as the *de facto* alternate media player for a Windows-based system, it supports music transfer, Via its iPod plugin (ml_ipod). Winamp though like iTunes, is extremely bloated and very heavy on system resources for a media player. The interface can also be slightly overwhelming for a new user.

Floola

The simplest of all iPod managers mentioned here, it runs as a single executable file. It's so light on system resources that it can even work on old Celeron 400 MHz systems. If you have a netbook and all you want to do is share music with your iPod, floola should serve as a good alternative. Support for newer iPods is an issue.

GtkPod

This one's a Floola for Linux. One point of note is that after editing your `/etc/fuse.conf` by removing `#` from `#user_allow_other` and installing a few libraries (`gvfs gvfs-backends gvfs-bin gvfs-fuse libgvfscommon0 ifuse libgpod-dev libgpod-common libiphone-utils libiphone0 python-iphone libplist++1 libplist-utils python-plist libusb-1.0-0 libusb-1.0-0-dev libusbmuxd1 usbmuxd`) this is one of the few Linux software that can support iPhone and iTouch transfer and sync music.



As Firefox add-ons add functionality to the core Songbird player, this one adds iPod support

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A		4	5	9	8	6	1	2	
B	8		9	7	2				5
C	7	6				5			4
D			6		5	7		4	9
E			4				6	7	
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G	4	5	3			8			6
H	6	8			7				3
I		9	7	5	6	3	4		